
TV tonight: how the Dunblane massacre led Britain to ban handguns

Published by

Hollie Richardson, Hannah J Davies, Phil Harrison

Estimated reading time

2 min

Added on

2026-03-12

Address

<https://www.theguardian.com/tv-and-radio/2026/mar/12/tv-tonight-dunblane-how-britain-banned-handguns-30th-anniversary>

TV tonight: how the Dunblane massacre led Britain to ban handguns

Dunblane: How Britain Banned Handguns

9pm, BBC Two

A former PE teacher talks with startling calmness as she opens this documentary by recalling 13 March 1996, the day a gunman entered a Dunblane primary school gym and rapidly fired at the adults and children there. It remains the deadliest firearms atrocity in the UK. Parents of the victims, TV presenter Lorraine Kelly, the former prime minister Tony Blair and others help to tell the story of the campaign that followed to outlaw private handguns. "There's an assumption that this horrific thing happened and guns were banned," says Kelly. "It didn't happen like that." *Hollie Richardson*

Tonight: Spring Clean – Keep, Chuck Or Cash In?

7.30pm, ITV1

It's time for the big annual clearout, and that is either very welcome news or a total headache for those living with "stress-inducing clutter" – which, according to this report, is nearly half of us in the UK. Can decluttering be good for your mental health? And what should you do with all that stuff? Helpful tips are here. *HR*

Dragons' Den

8pm, BBC One

Even after approximately 5,000 years on TV, Dragons' Den still finds new ways to surprise us. This week, there's a man in a chicken costume with an unusual idea for getting people out of the house, while beauty entrepreneur Jenna Meek proves a welcome regular addition to the panel. *Hannah J Davies*

Britain's Countryside Killer: True Crime Presents

9pm, ITV1

The true-crime strand continues with the examination of a case that was one of Scotland's most mysterious unsolved murders until a documentary helped to catch the killer. Ian Packer was found guilty of killing 27-year-old Emma Caldwell, but how did he evade justice for years? *HR*

Alexander Armstrong in India

9pm, Channel 5

The traveller is in colourful Jaipur and the first thing he does is fuel up on ... McDonald's! Then he learns more about the old Pink City and shops for diamond jewellery for his wife at a jeweller's that counted Diana, Princess of Wales and Gwyneth Paltrow as customers. Also on the itinerary: meeting monkeys and making silk. *HR*

Hunting Outback Gold

9pm, U&Yesterday

Part history, part adventure quest, this series is a low-key pleasure as Jeff Harris and Brendan Elliot search the outback for Harrold Lasseter's gold. This time, the tone turns melancholy as the speculative nature of the expedition becomes apparent. But the journey is the point: Australia's vast interior is unnerving but beautiful. *Phil Harrison*

Produced by wallabag with tcpdf

Please open [an issue](#) if you have trouble with the display of this E-Book on your device.